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Department of Human-Centred Computing

Monash University, Australia

Professor Florian 'Floyd' Mueller

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To Whom It May Concern,

I am Professor Florian “Floyd” Mueller, Director of Research in Human-Centred Computing at Monash University and a member of the ACM SIGCHI Academy. My work has been recognised globally, including receiving the prestigious “Tall Poppy” award for scientific excellence. It is with my strongest support that I recommend Mr. Xiang Li for his faculty application as an Assistant Professor.

I first worked with Xiang in 2020 during his research internship at my Exertion Games Lab, and I have since followed his development closely. Even as an undergraduate, Xiang showed creativity, maturity, and research ability well beyond his stage. Together with my group, he co-designed and developed projects such as Auto-Paizo Games (CHI PLAY 2023, Best Interactivity Audience Award) and Fused Spectatorship, which explored novel forms of bodily play through electrical muscle stimulation. Xiang’s original ideas and strong technical execution were central to these projects, and this collaboration led to publications at top-tier venues including ACM CHI, CHI PLAY, and TOCHI.

Since beginning his PhD at Cambridge with Professor Per Ola Kristensson in 2022, Xiang has built an impressive independent research profile. His first-author papers at IEEE TVCG, ACM SUI, ACM ISS, among others, demonstrate both technical depth and originality in his focus on body-centric interactions in mixed reality. In addition, he has already supervised several students, and his role as corresponding and last author has led to further significant publications, including contributions to IEEE TVCG and IEEE ISMAR.

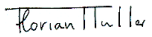
Notably, Xiang has been selected to represent Cambridge at the Stockholm International Youth Science Seminar (SIYSS) during Nobel Week 2025, the world’s preeminent forum for young scientists, for his groundbreaking VR selection disambiguation technique. He was also honored with the 2025 UKRI Innovate UK Immersive Tech Award for Technical Innovation, recognizing his pioneering integration of microgestures for seamless text editing in VR environments. His research further garnered prestigious accolades, including the 2025 IEEE ISMAR Best Paper Award Honourable Mention and 2022 IEEE VR Best Conference Paper Award nomination, among other distinctions. These accomplishments not only reflect his exceptional scholarly contributions but also demonstrate his remarkable ability to translate innovative research into impactful advancements with far-reaching influence beyond academia.

What sets Xiang apart is his clear vision for the future of intelligent systems in mixed reality, an area where he is already emerging as a thought leader. He combines technical innovation with strong design sensibility and has demonstrated leadership through supervising students and serving in program committees and conference organizing roles. Importantly, Xiang is fully ready to begin his independent faculty career. Among all the students and collaborators I have worked with, Xiang stands out as a true rising star, and I am confident

he will become one of the outstanding scholars shaping the next generation of HCI and XR research worldwide.

I therefore give Xiang Li my highest possible recommendation, without reservation. I also very much look forward to continuing to collaborate with him in the future, as I am certain he will make lasting and significant contributions to our field. Please feel free to contact me if you require further details.

Sincerely,



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